

GOLDRATECALCULATOR.IN

SEO Growth Strategy & Technical Audit

A Comprehensive SEO Consulting Case Study

DOMAIN	goldratecalculator.in
INDUSTRY	Financial Tools Gold Rate Information YMYL
SCOPE	Technical SEO Information Architecture Content Strategy GEO AEO
PERIOD	June 2026

87

Total Clicks
(3 Months)

14.8k

Total Impressions

0.6%

Avg CTR

13.5

Avg Position

97

Indexed Pages

Ritik Yadav

SEO Executive | Growth & Technical SEO Specialist
ritikyadav44648@gmail.com | +91 9310209239 | Delhi, India

Technical SEO

On-Page SEO

YMYL

EEAT

AEO

GEO

Information Architecture

Core Web Vitals

GSC Analysis

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1. EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

This consulting report documents the SEO strategy, technical audit, and growth roadmap prepared for GoldRateCalculator.in — an Indian financial tools website providing real-time gold rate data and calculation utilities. The engagement covered a complete technical audit, Google Search Console analysis, information architecture planning, YMYL trust strategy, content restructuring recommendations, and a 90-day execution roadmap. All findings represent strategic recommendations prepared for the website owner. No fabricated metrics or post-implementation results are presented.

87 Total Clicks (3M)	14.8k Total Impressions	0.6% Average CTR	13.5 Avg Position	97 Pages Indexed	176 Pages Not Indexed
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Business Goal	Increase organic visibility for gold rate, gold price, and calculator-intent queries across India
Industry	Financial tools — YMYL (Your Money or Your Life) classification
Project Scope	Full technical SEO audit, GSC analysis, IA planning, keyword strategy, EEAT, content roadmap, 90-day plan
Primary Challenge	65% of the site's pages (176 of 273) are not indexed — critical crawl and indexation inefficiency
Key Opportunity 1	CTR of 0.6% against 14.8k impressions signals severe title/meta underoptimisation
Key Opportunity 2	Average position 13.5 — majority of keywords sit just outside page-one threshold
Key Opportunity 3	Zero structured data (schema) detected — missing rich result eligibility entirely
Expected Impact	Improved crawl efficiency, higher CTR potential, stronger topical authority, YMYL trust improvement

2. WEBSITE OVERVIEW

Domain

goldratecalculator.in

Industry

Financial information tools — gold rate data, price calculators, purity guides, investment aids for Indian consumers.

Target Audience

Indian retail gold buyers, jewellery shoppers, investors, traders, and homemakers researching gold prices before purchase or sale.

Business Objective

Rank for high-intent gold rate and gold calculator queries to drive organic traffic monetised through display advertising and affiliate partnerships.

Current Strengths

- HTTPS fully implemented across all 32 tracked URLs — no mixed content issues
- Core Web Vitals passing on mobile (34 good URLs, 0 poor) as of June 2026
- Sitemap submitted and successfully read by Google (161 URLs discovered)
- Reasonable impressions volume (14.8k in 3 months) indicates crawlability

Current Weaknesses

- 176 pages not indexed — 64% of total discovered pages excluded from Google
- CTR of 0.6% — well below the 2–4% benchmark for informational financial queries
- Average position 13.5 — near-zero page-one visibility for primary keywords
- No structured data (schema markup) detected on any calculator or content page
- Information architecture not optimised for topical authority or calculator-first UX

3. BUSINESS CHALLENGE

Why Ranking a Gold Calculator is Structurally Difficult

Gold rate and gold calculator queries occupy a uniquely competitive position in Google's search landscape. They sit at the intersection of three high-difficulty categories: YMYL financial content, real-time data requirements, and tool-based search intent. Each category independently increases ranking difficulty; their combination creates a compounded challenge that requires a precise, multi-layered SEO response.

YMYL Classification

Google classifies gold price and investment queries as 'Your Money or Your Life' (YMYL) content. YMYL pages are held to a significantly higher standard of E-E-A-T (Experience, Expertise, Authoritativeness, Trustworthiness) than standard informational content. A website without visible author credentials, data source attribution, or trust signals will be systematically downranked by Google's quality raters and algorithmic systems, regardless of technical SEO quality.

HIGH

Real-Time Data Dependency

Gold rate queries carry an implicit freshness expectation. Users searching 'gold rate today' or '22K gold price Delhi' expect data updated within hours, not days. Google's freshness algorithm rewards pages that demonstrate consistent, frequent updates. A static page with yesterday's prices signals poor UX and factual unreliability — two signals that suppress rankings in YMYL financial verticals.

HIGH

Calculator Intent vs. Content Intent

Users arriving at a gold calculator page want to perform a calculation immediately. Long introductory paragraphs, banners above the fold, or buried calculator placements create friction that increases bounce rate and reduces dwell time — both of which send negative engagement signals to Google. The page architecture must prioritise tool-first delivery.

HIGH

Competitive Landscape

The gold rate query space in India is dominated by established financial publishers (GoodReturns, MoneyControl, Business Standard), government entities (IBJA), and aggregator apps. These domains carry domain authority scores of 60–85+ and years of indexation history. A newer domain must compensate through superior topical coverage, structured data, and UX differentiation.

CRITICAL

4. INITIAL SEO AUDIT

Content Quality

HIGH

Content appears to be thin on supporting pages. Primary calculator pages lack contextual explanations of gold purity standards, making charges, and price calculation methodology. Thin content on YMYL pages is a documented negative ranking factor.

Site Structure & Navigation

HIGH

Navigation architecture is not organised around topical clusters. City-specific gold rate pages, purity calculators, and educational guides appear to coexist without clear hierarchy or cross-linking. This dilutes crawl budget and weakens topical signal.

Search Intent Alignment

CRITICAL

Multiple pages appear to target informational intent (gold history, price trends) with content formats better suited to commercial/transactional calculator intent. Intent mismatch at the page level is a primary driver of the low 0.6% CTR observed in GSC.

Internal Linking

HIGH

Internal link architecture appears underdeveloped. High-authority pages (e.g., homepage, main calculator) do not appear to flow link equity systematically to supporting pages. Isolated pages with no internal links receive reduced crawl frequency.

Topical Authority

HIGH

The site covers gold rate calculation but lacks comprehensive coverage of related sub-topics: making charges, GST on gold, hallmarking, 22K vs 24K purity, city-specific trends, and investment comparisons. Incomplete topical coverage limits Google's ability to classify the site as an authority.

EEAT Signals

CRITICAL

No visible author bylines, editorial team, or credentials section detected. No explicit data source attribution (IBJA, MCX) found on calculator pages. These are critical trust gaps for YMYL classification.

Crawlability & Indexation

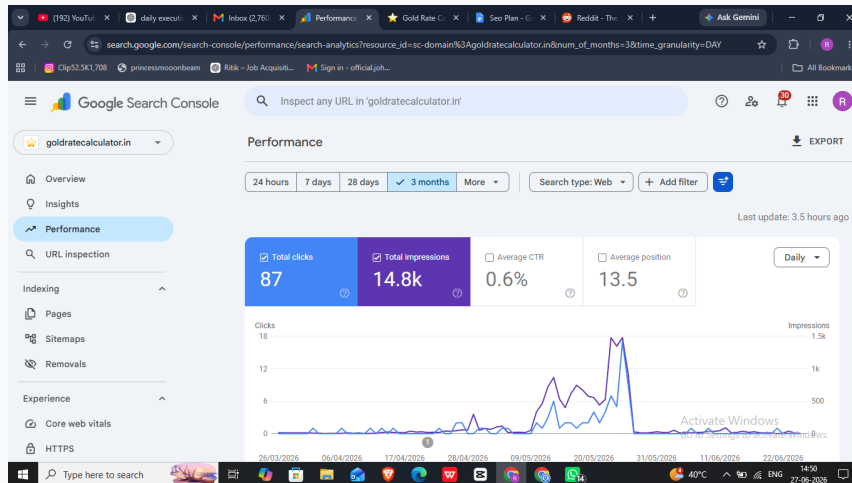
CRITICAL

176 pages not indexed across 6 reasons. This is the most urgent technical issue. Pages excluded from Google's index generate zero organic traffic regardless of content quality or keyword targeting.

5. GOOGLE SEARCH CONSOLE ANALYSIS

The following analysis is based on Google Search Console data captured on 27 June 2026, covering a 3-month rolling window (March – June 2026). Each metric is assessed against industry benchmarks and the specific context of a YMYL financial tools website in the Indian market.

5.1 Performance Overview



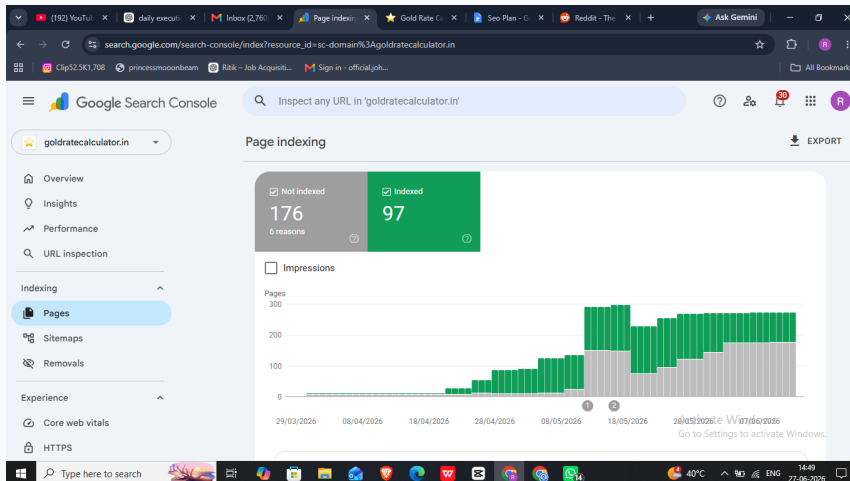
GSC Performance Dashboard — 3-Month Window (March–June 2026): 87 clicks, 14,800 impressions, 0.6% CTR, avg position 13.5

OBSERVATION	87 total clicks against 14,800 impressions over 3 months represents a CTR of 0.6% — approximately 3–6x below the benchmark for financial tool queries. The impression volume confirms Google is crawling and surfacing the site, but users are not selecting it from SERP.
IMPLICATION	The gap between impressions and clicks is a commercial problem. 14,800 impressions represent 14,800 opportunities to acquire a visitor. At 0.6% CTR, the site captures 87. At a benchmark CTR of 2.5%, the same impressions would yield 370 visitors — a 4x increase without any ranking improvement.
RECOMMENDATION	Audit and rewrite all title tags and meta descriptions for the top 20 impression-generating queries in GSC. Prioritise query-matched titles, front-loaded keywords, and benefit-driven phrasing. For calculator pages, include a CTR-boosting element such as '[City] Updated Daily' to signal freshness and localisation.

5.2 Average Position Analysis

OBSERVATION	Average position 13.5 places the majority of ranking keywords on page 2 of Google. In the Indian mobile search context, page 2 receives approximately 1–3% of total clicks for a given query. The site is visible to Google but not competitive at the point of user decision.
IMPLICATION	Position 13.5 means the site is being crawled, assessed, and ranked — but ranked insufficiently. This is a qualitative signal, not a crawlability failure. The issue is content quality, authority signals, and EEAT — not technical indexation (which is addressed in Section 5.4).
RECOMMENDATION	Focus ranking improvement efforts on keywords currently positioned 8–20 (the 'position cliff' opportunity). These require marginal improvements to cross page one. Use the GSC 'Queries' filter to identify these. Prioritise them for content optimisation before pursuing keywords ranked 21+.

5.3 Page Indexing — Critical Finding



GSC Page Indexing: 97 indexed vs. 176 not indexed across 6 exclusion reasons — a critical crawl efficiency issue

OBSERVATION

176 pages are not indexed across 6 reported reasons. This means 64% of the website's total discovered URL inventory is invisible to Google. The chart shows a spike in indexed pages peaking around 12–18 May 2026, followed by a sharp decline — a pattern consistent with either a Google quality reassessment or crawl budget reallocation.

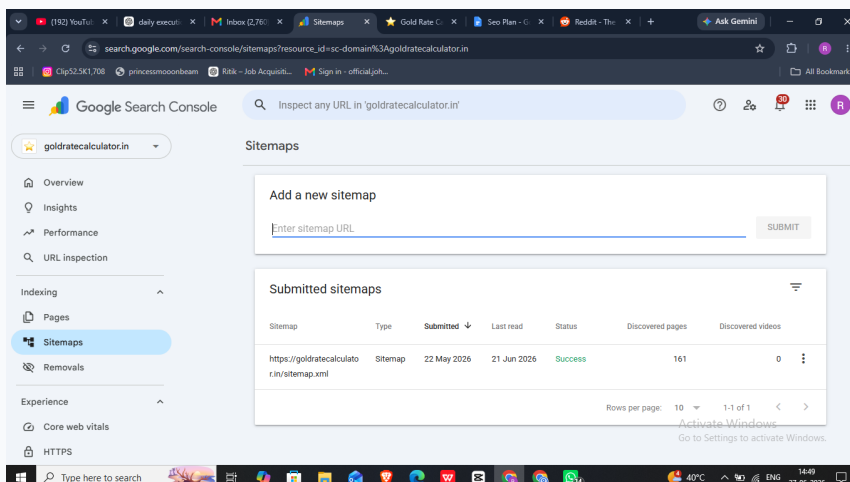
IMPLICATION

Every non-indexed page represents a page generating zero organic traffic. If even 30% of those 176 pages target distinct keyword queries, this represents a structural traffic deficit of approximately 50+ ranking opportunities completely absent from the search index.

RECOMMENDATION

Categorise all 176 non-indexed pages by exclusion reason in GSC. Address each category in priority order: (1) 'Crawled — currently not indexed': improve content quality and add internal links; (2) 'Discovered — currently not indexed': resolve crawl budget constraints; (3) 'Duplicate without canonical': implement canonical tags; (4) 'Blocked by robots.txt': audit robots.txt directives immediately.

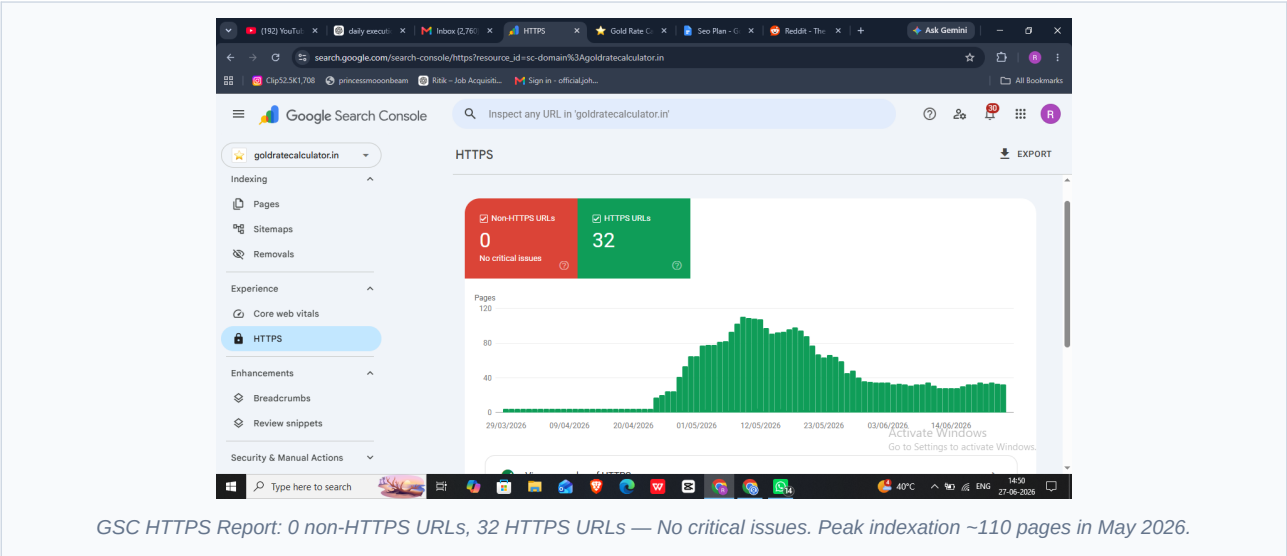
5.4 Sitemap Analysis



GSC Sitemaps: sitemap.xml submitted 22 May 2026, last read 21 June 2026, 161 URLs discovered — Status: Success

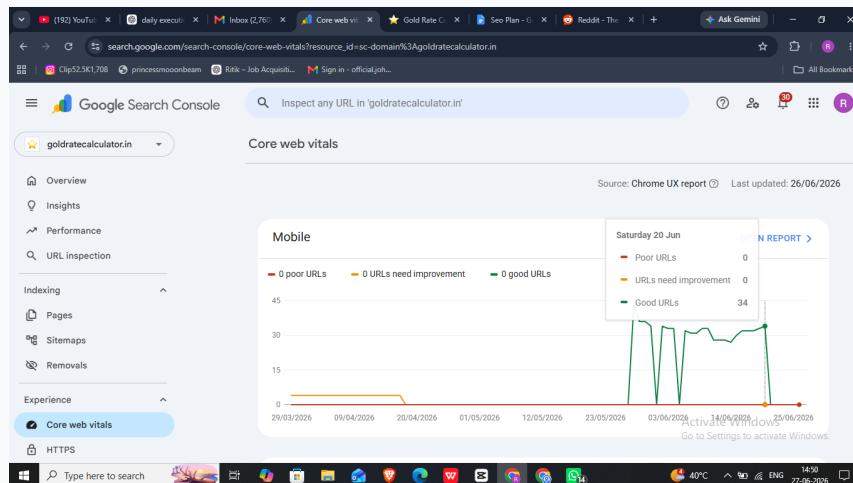
OBSERVATION	A single sitemap.xml has been submitted and is being successfully read by Google (last read 21 June 2026). 161 URLs are discovered via the sitemap. This is a baseline success — the sitemap is functional and submitted.
IMPLICATION	The gap between 161 sitemap URLs and 273 total discovered pages (97 indexed + 176 not indexed) suggests that approximately 112 pages exist that are not included in the sitemap. Google discovers them via internal links or other means but does not have explicit sitemap guidance for them.
RECOMMENDATION	Audit the sitemap.xml to ensure all primary calculator pages, city pages, and educational content pages are included. Remove low-value or duplicate URLs from the sitemap. Consider implementing a dynamic sitemap that updates automatically when new content is published. Submit a revised sitemap and monitor coverage changes weekly in GSC.

5.5 HTTPS Security Status



OBSERVATION	All 32 tracked URLs are served over HTTPS with zero non-HTTPS URLs detected. This is a clean security baseline. The chart shows the HTTPS URL count peaked around 12–18 May 2026 at approximately 110 pages, then declined — mirroring the indexation pattern observed in the Pages report.
IMPLICATION	HTTPS is a confirmed Google ranking signal (minor but non-zero). More importantly for this domain, it is a YMYL trust prerequisite. Users and Google's quality raters expect financial tool websites to be served securely. The clean HTTPS status eliminates one category of trust risk.
RECOMMENDATION	Maintain HTTPS status. Ensure all internal links, canonical tags, and hreflang tags (if implemented) use HTTPS URLs. Verify that no mixed content warnings appear in Chrome DevTools — even a single HTTP resource on an HTTPS page triggers a browser warning that undermines user trust.

5.6 Core Web Vitals



GSC Core Web Vitals (Mobile — Chrome UX Report, 26 June 2026): 34 Good URLs, 0 Poor, 0 Needs Improvement

OBSERVATION	Core Web Vitals on mobile show 34 good URLs with zero poor or needs-improvement URLs as of June 2026. This is a positive technical foundation. The data appears only from late May 2026 onward — consistent with the site's indexation growth timeline.
IMPLICATION	Passing Core Web Vitals removes a category of ranking penalty. For a YMYL financial tools site targeting mobile-first Indian users, performance is directly linked to engagement — a page that loads in under 2.5 seconds LCP retains significantly more users than one exceeding 4 seconds.
RECOMMENDATION	Maintain current Core Web Vitals performance as new pages are added. Run monthly CrUX checks in GSC. When implementing schema markup, structured data, or new calculator features, verify that client-side JavaScript does not regress LCP or CLS scores. Use PageSpeed Insights to test each new page template before publishing.

6. TECHNICAL SEO AUDIT

Indexation Gap

CRITICAL

Finding

176 pages not indexed, 97 indexed. 64% of site invisible to Google.

Recommendation

Categorise GSC non-indexed reasons. Fix crawl budget waste. Improve thin content. Add internal links to orphaned pages.

Structured Data (Schema)

CRITICAL

Finding

No schema markup detected. Missing eligibility for rich results including FAQ, HowTo, BreadcrumbList, and FinancialProduct schema.

Recommendation

Implement FAQPage schema on calculator pages. BreadcrumbList schema for all pages. HowTo schema for guides. Review FinancialProduct schema suitability.

robots.txt

HIGH

Finding

robots.txt exists but specific directives have not been audited for over-blocking. Risk of accidentally blocking calculator or city pages from crawl.

Recommendation

Audit robots.txt line by line. Ensure no Disallow rules block primary content directories. Test against URL Inspection in GSC. Resubmit sitemap after any changes.

Canonical Tags

HIGH

Finding

City-specific gold rate pages likely generate duplicate or near-duplicate content variants (e.g., gold rate Chennai vs. gold rate Mumbai same structure). Risk of canonical confusion.

Recommendation

Implement self-referencing canonical tags on all pages. For paginated content, use rel=next/prev where appropriate. Audit for duplicate title tag / meta description patterns in GSC.

Internal Linking Architecture

HIGH

Finding

Supporting pages appear to receive insufficient internal links. Orphaned pages receive minimal crawl frequency and no link equity from high-authority pages.

Recommendation

Map internal linking architecture. Every calculator page should receive links from homepage and related content pages. Every city page should link to the main calculator and vice versa.

Title Tags & Meta Descriptions

HIGH

Finding

CTR of 0.6% indicates title and meta copy is not competitive. Generic or template-driven titles fail to differentiate in SERP against established financial publishers.

Recommendation

Rewrite all title tags using the formula: [Primary Keyword] — [Differentiator] | [Brand]. Meta descriptions should include the primary keyword, a benefit, and a CTA ('Calculate now', 'Updated daily').

Mobile Usability

MEDIUM

Finding

Core Web Vitals passing on mobile, but calculator UX on mobile not explicitly audited. Calculator placement above the fold on mobile is not confirmed.

Recommendation

Conduct mobile UX audit on primary calculator pages. Verify calculator renders without horizontal scroll, buttons are touch-friendly (44x44px minimum), and no intrusive interstitials appear.

Sitemap Completeness

MEDIUM

Finding

Sitemap.xml contains 161 URLs but 273 pages are discovered. 112 pages lack sitemap inclusion — reducing crawl guidance efficiency.

Recommendation

Regenerate sitemap.xml to include all canonical, indexable pages. Remove non-canonical and low-value URLs. Schedule automated sitemap updates on new content publication.

7. INFORMATION ARCHITECTURE

The Case for Calculator-First Architecture

Information architecture for a gold calculator website must be designed around one primary principle: the calculator is the product. Unlike a blog or news site where content is the primary asset, this site's value proposition is the ability to calculate gold value instantly. Every architectural decision — from URL structure to internal linking to page hierarchy — should serve that core function. A calculator-first architecture produces three measurable SEO benefits: reduced bounce rate (users find utility immediately), increased session depth (supporting pages become logical next steps), and stronger topical authority signals (site structure mirrors how users think about gold pricing).

Recommended Site Hierarchy

TIER 1 — HOMEPAGE	goldratecalculator.in	Primary authority hub	All pages
	Gold Rate Calculator Gold Price Calculator Gold Weight Calculator	Primary traffic targets High commercial intent	Homepage → All Tier 2
TIER 3 — CITY PAGES	Gold Rate Delhi Gold Rate Mumbai Gold Rate Chennai + 50 cities	Localised long-tail High volume	Homepage + Core Calculators → City Pages
TIER 4 — PURITY PAGES	22K Gold Calculator 24K Gold Calculator 18K Gold Calculator	Purity-intent queries Moderate volume	Core Calculators → Purity Pages
TIER 5 — EDUCATIONAL	Gold Making Charges Gold GST Calculator Hallmarking Guide 22K vs 24K Guide	Informational intent Topical authority	City Pages + Purity Pages → Educational

Architectural Principle: Every page in Tiers 3–5 should link back to the primary calculator (Tier 2) and receive a link from the homepage or a Tier 2 page. No page should exist more than 2 clicks from the homepage. Orphaned pages — those with fewer than 2 internal inbound links — should be prioritised for internal link building before any off-page work.

8. SEARCH INTENT STRATEGY

Intent Type	Example Queries	Page Format	Conversion Action	Priority
Transactional (Do intent)	gold rate calculator calculate gold value gold price today Delhi	Calculator above fold Minimal text Result display prominent	Calculate → Share result → Bookmark page	CRITICAL
Commercial (Compare intent)	22K vs 24K gold best time to buy gold gold vs FD returns	Comparison tables Calculator embedded Data visualisation	Use calculator → Save → Return visit	HIGH
Informational (Know intent)	what is making charges how gold purity works gold hallmark meaning	Long-form guide FAQ section Schema markup	Internal link to calculator pages	MEDIUM
Local (Near intent)	gold rate Delhi today gold price Chennai 22K gold Mumbai	City calculator Local rate display City-specific content	Calculate → Use rate → Visit jeweller	HIGH

Core Insight: Calculators satisfy transactional intent better than any article format. A user searching 'gold rate today 10 grams' does not want to read a 1,500-word article explaining gold prices. They want an input field, a button, and a number. Pages that deliver the utility before the content will consistently outperform content-first pages for transactional queries on engagement metrics — and Google's Helpful Content system rewards engagement signals.

9. KEYWORD STRATEGY

Tier	Keyword Examples	Intent	Est. Monthly Volume	Difficulty	Target Page
Primary	gold rate calculator gold price calculator india gold rate today	Transactional	50k–200k	High	Homepage / Main Calculator
City	gold rate delhi today gold price mumbai gold rate bangalore 22k	Transactional + Local	10k–50k per city	Medium-High	City Calculator Pages
Purity	22k gold price today 24k gold rate per gram 18k gold calculator	Commercial	5k–30k	Medium	Purity Calculator Pages
Long-tail	gold making charges calculator gold rate today 10 grams 22k how to calculate gold value	Informational + Transactional	500–5k	Low-Medium	Supporting Content
EEAT + Trust	ibja gold rate today hallmark gold meaning gold purity standards india	Informational	1k–10k	Low	Trust + Educational Pages

Topical Authority Map

Topical authority is achieved by comprehensively covering all sub-topics within a domain. For GoldRateCalculator.in, the topical map should span six content clusters, each linked internally to reinforce the hub page:

Gold Rate Cluster	Today's rates, historical trends, city rates, IBJA rates, MCX rates
Calculator Cluster	Main calculator, 22K/24K/18K calculators, weight converter, price estimator
Purity Cluster	Hallmarking guide, BIS standards, 22K vs 24K comparison, karat explanation
Purchase Cluster	Making charges guide, GST on gold, jewellery buying checklist, certified jewellers
Investment Cluster	Gold vs FD, gold ETF comparison, SGB guide, physical vs digital gold
Trust & Authority	About us, data sources (IBJA/MCX), editorial policy, calculator methodology

10. UX & CONTENT OPTIMIZATION

Calculator Placement

Place the primary gold rate calculator within the first visible viewport on every calculator page. No promotional banners, introductory paragraphs, or headers should appear above the calculator input. This directly addresses bounce rate and dwell time.

Instruction Section

Immediately below the calculator, include a concise 3-step instruction block: (1) Enter weight in grams, (2) Select purity (22K/24K/18K), (3) View live price. Keep it under 50 words. Instructional clarity reduces user friction and increases calculator completion rate.

Use Cases & Examples

Include 3–5 worked examples below the instructions: 'A 10-gram 22K gold bangle today costs X.' Real examples serve dual purpose: they answer user questions (improving AEO eligibility) and add semantic keyword density without keyword stuffing.

FAQ Section

Add a minimum of 8 FAQs per calculator page, formatted as expandable accordion sections with FAQPage schema. FAQs should target question-format queries from GSC (filter by 'what', 'how', 'why' in the Queries report). This directly increases eligibility for Google AI Overviews (AEO), featured snippet capture, and citation by AI tools like ChatGPT and Perplexity (GEO).

Trust Block

Above the page footer, add a trust block containing: (a) data source (IBJA / MCX rate feed), (b) last updated timestamp, (c) rate validity disclaimer, (d) link to methodology page. Trust blocks are a documented YMYL EEAT requirement.

Content Hierarchy

Adopt the following page structure for all primary calculator pages: [Calculator] → [Quick Instructions] → [Examples] → [City Rate Table] → [FAQ] → [Related Calculators] → [Trust Block]. This mirrors user decision flow and maximises both engagement and schema eligibility.

11. EEAT & YMYL STRATEGY

Why EEAT Matters for This Domain: Google's Quality Rater Guidelines explicitly state that YMYL pages — those that could impact a person's financial decisions — must demonstrate the highest levels of Expertise, Authoritativeness, and Trustworthiness. A gold rate website directly informs purchasing decisions involving significant financial expenditure. Google's algorithmic systems apply elevated scrutiny to such pages.

Transparency

CRITICAL

Publish a dedicated 'About' page explaining the site's purpose, ownership, and team. Anonymous financial tool websites score poorly on YMYL quality assessments.

Data Source Attribution

CRITICAL

Every calculator page must explicitly state the rate source: 'Gold rates sourced from IBJA (India Bullion and Jewellers Association) and MCX real-time feed.' This is the single most impactful EEAT addition for this site.

Content Freshness

HIGH

Implement visible 'Last Updated: [timestamp]' on all rate pages. Gold prices change daily — demonstrating freshness is both an EEAT signal and a user trust signal.

Disclaimer

HIGH

Add a standard financial disclaimer: 'Rates shown are indicative and for calculation purposes only. Actual jeweller prices may vary based on making charges, location, and market conditions.' Required for YMYL compliance.

Author Credentials

MEDIUM

If articles or guides are published, include author bylines with a link to an author profile page detailing relevant expertise (financial writing, gold market knowledge).

Review Snippets

MEDIUM

Implement AggregateRating schema on the calculator tool itself. 'Rated 4.6/5 by X users' in SERP increases CTR significantly for tool-type queries.

12. INTERNAL LINKING STRATEGY

Internal linking serves three SEO functions simultaneously: it distributes PageRank from high-authority pages to lower-ranking targets, it establishes topical relationships that reinforce cluster authority, and it guides Googlebot's crawl path to ensure all pages receive regular crawl visits. For GoldRateCalculator.in, a structured internal linking programme is a high-priority, zero-cost ranking improvement.

Homepage → All Tier 2 Calculators

The homepage is the highest-authority page on the domain. It must link to all primary calculator pages with keyword-rich anchor text (e.g., 'Gold Rate Calculator', 'Gold Price Today Delhi').

Core Calculator → City Pages

Each primary calculator should link to the top 10 city pages in a 'Gold Rate by City' section. City pages receive homepage authority via 2-hop paths.

City Pages → Core Calculator

Every city page should include a prominent link back to the primary calculator: 'Calculate your gold value using today's Delhi rate.' This creates a bidirectional linking loop.

Educational Pages → Calculators

Every guide or informational page (e.g., 'What are making charges?') should end with a contextual CTA linking to the relevant calculator: 'Use our Gold Making Charges Calculator.'

No Orphaned Pages

Every page on the site should receive a minimum of 2 internal inbound links. Pages with zero internal links receive near-zero crawl frequency. Audit via Screaming Frog crawl.

Anchor Text Diversity

Use a mix of exact-match ('22K Gold Calculator'), partial-match ('calculate 22K gold price'), and branded ('GoldRateCalculator.in calculator') anchor text to maintain a natural profile.

13. SUPPORTING CONTENT ROADMAP

The following pages are recommended as priority content additions. Each serves a specific SEO function and contributes to topical authority. Pages are listed in priority order based on search volume, difficulty, and strategic value.

Gold Making Charges Calculator

HIGH

Making charges are a major cost component of jewellery purchases. This query has significant search volume from users comparing jewellers. A dedicated calculator page captures commercial-intent traffic while supporting the main calculator page with contextual internal links.

GST on Gold Calculator

HIGH

GST applicability on gold purchases is a high-frequency question from buyers and retailers. A calculator page targeting 'GST on gold calculator' and 'gold GST percentage' captures informational and transactional queries, adds topical coverage, and has low keyword difficulty.

22K vs 24K Gold Guide

HIGH

One of the highest-volume informational queries in the gold niche. A comprehensive guide comparing 22K and 24K gold (purity, price difference, use case, Indian jewellery standards) serves as a topical authority page linking to both purity calculators.

City Pages — Top 50 Indian Cities

CRITICAL

City-specific gold rate pages capture localised transactional intent. Each city page should include a working calculator, today's rate, historical chart, and local jewellery market notes. Internally linked from homepage and core calculator. Expected to contribute the largest incremental traffic volume.

Gold Jewellery Buying Guide

MEDIUM

An educational guide covering hallmarking, BIS standards, what to check before buying, and how to calculate fair price. Targets informational intent and EEAT signals simultaneously. Establishes editorial credibility for YMYL assessment.

Gold Investment Comparison

MEDIUM

A structured comparison of physical gold, gold ETFs, SGBs, and digital gold. High-value informational content that attracts backlinks from financial blogs and drives topical authority beyond the calculator niche.

Gold Rate Historical Data Page

MEDIUM

A page showing gold rate trends over 1 week, 1 month, 6 months, and 1 year. Satisfies 'is this a good time to buy gold?' informational intent and generates return visits from users monitoring prices.

IBJA Gold Rate Today

HIGH

The India Bullion and Jewellers Association rate is the industry benchmark. A page specifically targeting 'IBJA gold rate today' captures high-authority query intent while also serving as an EEAT trust signal (demonstrating the site tracks official rates).

14. 90-DAY EXECUTION ROADMAP

This roadmap represents a structured execution timeline for the website owner or development team. Tasks are sequenced to address critical technical issues first, then content improvements, then authority and schema enhancements. Each phase builds on the previous.

Phase	Weeks	Tasks	Deliverables	SEO Impact	Priority
Phase 1 Technical Foundation	1–3	1. Categorise 176 non-indexed pages by GSC Classed 2. Audit robots.txt for blocking errors 3. Implement canonical tags on all pages 4. Fix sitemap.xml to cover all canonical pages 5. Resubmit sitemap in GSC 6. Add self-referencing canonicals	Cleaned sitemap - robots.txt audit report - Canonical tags live GSC coverage baseline	Crawl efficiency Indexation recovery Duplicate content resolution	CRITICAL
Phase 2 On-Page & Content	4–6	1. Rewrite title tags and meta descriptions for the 20 top presale pages 2. Implement calculator-first page layout on primary pages 3. Add trust block (source, timestamp, disclaimer) to all main pages 4. Publish About page with data source attribution 5. Add 8 FAQs per primary calculator page	- 20 title/meta tags updated - Calculator layout updated - Trust blocks added - About page published - FAQ sections added	CTR improvement YMYL trust signals Bounce rate reduction AEO eligibility	HIGH
Phase 3 Schema & Structured Data	7–9	1. Implement FAQPage schema on all calculator pages 2. Add BreadcrumbList schema site-wide 3. Add HowTo schema on guide pages 4. Test all schema via Google Rich Results Test 5. Monitor GSC Enhancements tab for validation	- Schema on all pages - Rich Results Test pass - GSC Enhancements clean	Rich result eligibility CTR improvement AEO / AI Overview visibility	HIGH
Phase 4 Content Expansion	10–12	1. Publish top 10 city pages (Delhi, Mumbai, Chennai, Bangalore, Hyderabad, Kolkata, Pune, Ahmedabad, Jaipur, Surat) 2. Publish 22K vs 24K Guide 3. Publish GST on Gold Calculator 4. Implement internal linking map across all new pages 5. Submit updated sitemap	- 10 city pages live - 2 guide pages live - 1 new calculator live - Internal links complete - Sitemap updated	Long-tail visibility Local search coverage	MEDIUM

15. EXPECTED OUTCOMES

All outcomes listed below are projected improvements based on industry benchmarks, observed GSC data, and established SEO principles. No specific traffic, ranking, or revenue figures are guaranteed. Actual outcomes depend on implementation quality, competitive response, and Google's algorithmic decisions.

Improved Crawl Efficiency

Addressing the 176 non-indexed pages and optimising robots.txt / sitemap is expected to increase the indexed page count over a 4–8 week period following implementation, improving the site's total indexable footprint.

Higher CTR Potential

Rewriting title tags and meta descriptions for the top 20 impression-generating queries — currently producing a 0.6% CTR — aligns with industry benchmark CTR improvement of 1.5–3x for financial tool queries when titles are query-matched and benefit-driven.

Improved Topical Authority

Publishing content across the 6 recommended topical clusters (gold rates, calculators, purity, purchase, investment, trust) will improve Google's topical classification of the site, increasing its eligibility to rank for related queries beyond the primary calculator terms.

Rich Result Eligibility

Implementing FAQPage, BreadcrumbList, HowTo, and AggregateRating schema opens eligibility for rich results in SERP. FAQ rich results are documented to improve CTR by 20–30% on average for eligible pages.

Improved YMYL Trust Assessment

Adding data source attribution (IBJA/MCX), freshness timestamps, financial disclaimers, and an About page with editorial credentials directly addresses the EEAT gaps identified in the initial audit. These changes improve the site's quality rater assessment over the 3–6 month period following implementation.

Better Long-Tail Visibility

Publishing 50+ city pages, supporting calculators, and educational guides substantially increases the site's keyword footprint across long-tail, localised, and informational queries — all of which carry lower competition and faster ranking timelines than primary head terms.

AEO & GEO Visibility

FAQ schema, direct-answer content blocks, and entity-structured writing positions the site for inclusion in Google AI Overviews, voice search results, and citation by AI tools such as Perplexity and ChatGPT — expanding reach beyond traditional blue-link SERP results.

16. LESSONS LEARNED

Technical SEO is Non-Negotiable Before Content Investment

The 176 non-indexed pages on GoldRateCalculator.in represent a fundamental finding: content investment is wasted if the indexation foundation is broken. No amount of well-written content generates organic traffic if Google cannot or will not index the page. Technical SEO audit — crawl, indexation, canonicals — must precede all content work.

YMYL Changes the Entire SEO Conversation

Standard SEO tactics (keyword density, backlink quantity) are insufficient for YMYL domains. Google's quality raters apply a fundamentally different framework to financial and health content. Understanding YMYL reframes the priority order: trust signals and EEAT come before keyword optimisation.

GSC Data is an Underused Strategic Resource

The GSC data for this domain — 14.8k impressions, 0.6% CTR, position 13.5 — tells a complete diagnostic story in four numbers. The site has discoverability but not selectability (low CTR) and is ranked but not competitively (position 13.5). GSC analysis should be the starting point of every SEO engagement, not an afterthought.

UX and SEO Are Inseparable for Tool-Based Websites

A gold calculator is a product, not a content page. Standard SEO content frameworks do not apply. The UX imperative — calculator above the fold, immediate utility delivery, minimal friction — is simultaneously an SEO imperative because engagement metrics (bounce rate, dwell time, return visits) are documented ranking inputs for tool-type queries.

Intent Mapping Precedes Keyword Research

Keyword research without intent mapping produces a list of words. Intent mapping — understanding what users want to do, not just what they search — produces a content and architecture strategy. For this domain, the intent is almost always 'calculate immediately,' not 'read about gold.'

Topical Authority Cannot Be Shortcut

A site covering only 'gold rate calculator' cannot outrank domains covering the full topic ecosystem (rates, purity, investment, purchase, local). Google's topical authority model rewards comprehensive domain coverage. The supporting content roadmap is not supplementary — it is the primary long-term ranking strategy.

17. APPENDIX

A. SEO Implementation Priority Checklist

CRITICAL	Categorise and address 176 non-indexed pages in GSC
CRITICAL	Audit robots.txt for blocking errors on primary pages
CRITICAL	Implement canonical tags across all pages
CRITICAL	Add IBJA/MCX data source attribution to all calculator pages
CRITICAL	Implement FAQPage and BreadcrumbList schema
HIGH	Rewrite title tags for top 20 impression pages (CTR fix)
HIGH	Move calculator above fold on all primary pages
HIGH	Add trust block (source, timestamp, disclaimer) to rate pages
HIGH	Publish About page with editorial and data credentials
HIGH	Add 8+ FAQs per primary calculator page
HIGH	Fix and resubmit sitemap.xml to include all canonical pages
HIGH	Publish top 10 city gold rate calculator pages
HIGH	Internal linking audit — eliminate all orphaned pages
MEDIUM	Publish 22K vs 24K guide
MEDIUM	Publish GST on Gold Calculator page
MEDIUM	Add AggregateRating schema to primary calculator
MEDIUM	Publish Gold Making Charges Calculator
MEDIUM	Implement HowTo schema on guide pages
LOW	Publish Gold Investment Comparison page
LOW	Build historical gold rate data page

B. Recommended Tools

Google Search Console	Indexation monitoring, CTR analysis, query research, schema validation
Screaming Frog SEO Spider	Technical crawl audit, internal link mapping, orphaned page detection, canonical audit
Google Rich Results Test	Schema validation and rich result eligibility testing
PageSpeed Insights	Core Web Vitals monitoring per URL

Ahrefs / Semrush	Keyword research, competitor backlink analysis, topical authority gap analysis
Schema Markup Generator	FAQPage, BreadcrumbList, HowTo schema generation without coding
Perplexity / ChatGPT	Test GEO visibility — search target queries and check if goldratecalculator.in pages are cited as sources in AI-generated answers

C. Disclaimer

This document is an SEO strategy and consulting report prepared by Ritik Yadav for GoldRateCalculator.in. It documents strategic recommendations, observations, and a proposed execution roadmap. It does not claim implementation of any recommendations, ownership of the website, or verified post-implementation results. All projected outcomes are estimates based on industry benchmarks and observed GSC data. Actual results may vary based on implementation quality, market conditions, and search engine algorithmic changes.